

ShopNest - Local Setup Guide

Windows Installation & Configuration Instructions

Step 1: Clone the Project

Clone the repository using Git to your local machine in your projects directory.

Current Directory: C:\Projects (or any folder of your choice)

```
git clone
```

Step 2: Navigate to the Root Folder

Move into the project's root folder.

Current Directory: C:\Projects

```
cd shopnest
```

Step 3: Install All Dependencies

Install dependencies for the root, frontend, and backend environments concurrently using the package script.

Current Directory: C:\Projects\shopnest

```
npm run install-all
```

Step 4: Create the Environment File (.env)

Copy the environment template in the backend folder and fill in your MongoDB URI, API keys, and credentials.

Current Directory: C:\Projects\shopnest

For Command Prompt (CMD):
`copy backend\.env.example backend\.env`

For PowerShell:
`Copy-Item backend\.env.example backend\.env`

Step 5: Seed the Database

Seed mock e-commerce products and create the default administrator account. Ensure MongoDB is running first.

Current Directory: C:\Projects\shopnest

```
npm run seed
```

Step 6: Start the Frontend & Backend Servers

Run the local development environment. This boots the frontend on port 3000 and the backend on port 5000.

Current Directory: C:\Projects\shopnest

```
npm start  
(or npm run dev)
```

Default Seeder Admin Account Credentials

- **Email:** *admin@shopnest.com*
- **Password:** *password123*